



Valve most desirable?

According to a recent poll, game developers chose Valve as their most desired game company. <http://dgit.in/SweetValve>



Corrigendum

Apologies to our readers for misprinting the name of Mr Hari Vasudev, VP & Head, Yahoo India R&D last month <http://dgit.in/YahooDigit>

Changing Cricket with Tech

To redefine how cricket is “administered, shared, analysed and followed,” a bunch of ex-cricketers have started CricHQ, a unique online portal that combines elements of social network with cricketing data and stats, and much more, to give followers of the game a new lens to look through. Excerpts from our exclusive interview:

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Over 70 percent of CricHQ is owned by cricketers. What was their inspiration?

Sewell: New Zealand businessman Simon Baker founded CricHQ in April 2010 in partnership with international cricketers Stephen Fleming and Brendon McCullum. Simon's inspiration behind CricHQ was to combine his passion for cricket with his skills and experience gained in a successful international career in technology and business development. He dreamed of forming a global technology company that would redefine how cricket is administered, shared, analysed and followed. This vision required the involvement of the world's best cricketing brains and access to the Cricket data across levels. Simon approached New Zealand cricketing legend Stephen Fleming and current New Zealand Captain Brendon McCullum, who agreed to become founding investors. The company has grown from strength to strength and as of now, it has attracted investments from 20 international cricketers, totaling nearly \$10 million. Well-known names like Ravi Ashwin, David Hussey, Michael Hussey, George Bailey, Albie Morkel, Faf du Plessis, Brad Hodge feature among the investors, including the New Zealand government.

Is CricHQ just another “social network” or is there more to it than meets the eye?

Sewell: There's definitely more to CricHQ than what people get to see. CricHQ is the world's first cricket technology platform with three distinct yet interrelated pillars: data, administration and social network.

As the first and a hugely critical pillar, CricHQ's data platform seeks to capture data around every ball that gets bowled in any professional Cricket match across



Jarred Sewell
Chief Marketing Officer, CricHQ

levels, across the world. What this means is in the near future, let's say a new Cricketer joins the Indian test team, you as a Cricket fan would be able to use the CricHQ platform to track and analyze his scores and performance right from the school or district level. For people who like watching Cricket, this will provide an unprecedented access to data and information about their favorite game and players.

Having the world's biggest database of granular cricketing information opens up some really exciting opportunities in the fields of High Performance, Media and other data distribution outlets.

The second and related pillar of the CricHQ platform is Cricket administration. Our platform is used by many Cricket administration bodies around the world for scoring and managing tournaments for example. In India, we already have two Cricket associations as our clients, and we are expecting to sign more.

Finally, the third pillar is a cricket social network, designed exclusively for

the Cricket fans, which allows them to follow their favourite players and receive notifications whenever they play cricket or share social updates. For users, the CricHQ platform is accessible through website and mobile apps available for iOS, Android and Windows devices. At the backend, we have a strong team of engineers, designers and visualizers, data capture specialists and analysts who are all working together to deliver a truly world-class experience to all users, be it a 12-year old fan, 21-year old amateur Cricketer or a senior Cricket administrator.

How is technology helping change the way cricket is played?

Sewell: In cricket, technologies like third umpire, hawk eye, hot spot and Speed gun have changed the game completely. It has made possible providing on the spot accurate game decisions and enhancing players' performance.

CricHQ is playing its part in revolutionizing the game. With its run-worms, graphs, instant calculations of key stats and visual representations, players can review their performances and coaches can deliver improved coaching at all levels. CricHQ effectively delivers what has previously only been available at the elite level of the game and provides that functionality throughout all levels of cricket. Players from all over the world can compile a history of their cricket and share their successes with their friends and families.

Keeping tabs on the performance of players at all levels and introducing new ways to analyse those performances helps unravel talents at a very early stage from across the country. **1**

Read the full, unabridged interview online.
Visit <http://dgit.in/CricHQDigit>